ENGLISH C2 · ADVANCED GRAMMAR

Genre-sensitive grammar

Adapt clause type, agency, density and stance to the communicative conventions of reports, essays, instructions and conversation. The lesson connects form, meaning, register and real editorial decisions rather than treating the pattern as an isolated rule.

THE CENTRAL IDEA

Use genre-sensitive grammar to choose grammar that fulfils a genre's social purpose rather than merely sounding formal while preserving the intended meaning and register.

Adapt clause type, agency, density and stance to the communicative conventions of reports, essays, instructions and conversation.

MODEL

Please restart the unit. / The unit should be restarted before further testing.

stable proposition + genre purpose -> grammar and information design

6 GUIDED STAGES · 30 LEARNING DECISIONS

This complete guide combines explanation, visual reasoning, practice and feedback. Separate exercise and answer-key editions are also available from the lesson page.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

OUTCOME 1

01

Recognise the main genre-sensitive grammar patterns in authentic contexts.

OUTCOME 2

02

Choose a form that accurately expresses choose grammar that fulfils a genre's social purpose rather than merely sounding formal.

OUTCOME 3

03

Avoid errors that change time, agency, emphasis or speaker commitment.

OUTCOME 4

04

Use the structure appropriately in cross-genre editing at proficient level.

Build meaning before form

Adapt clause type, agency, density and stance to the communicative conventions of reports, essays, instructions and conversation.

What genre-sensitive grammar communicates

Adapt clause type, agency, density and stance to the communicative conventions of reports, essays, instructions and conversation.

The central purpose is to choose grammar that fulfils a genre's social purpose rather than merely sounding formal. A successful choice therefore preserves the proposition while making the intended relationship, viewpoint or degree of commitment visible to the reader.

Restart the unit before running the diagnostic again.	direct action sequence with an explicit actor implied
The unit was restarted before the diagnostic was repeated.	a documented process with the sequence and result foregrounded
The restart appears to have reduced, rather than eliminated, the fault.	a calibrated interpretation of evidence

How the pattern is built

Use this working formula: stable proposition + genre purpose -> grammar and information design. The formula is a decision path: it identifies the trigger, the clause architecture and the element that carries tense or modality.

The model "Please restart the unit. / The unit should be restarted before further testing." shows the complete pattern in context. Rebuild the sentence from meaning to form instead of translating each word independently.

Choice	Structure	Example
Instructional grammar	imperative/clear modal + ordered action	Restart the unit before running the diagnostic again.
Report grammar	passive/result-first + explicit evidence	The unit was restarted before the diagnostic was repeated.
Analytical grammar	stance + abstract relation + evidence boundary	The restart appears to have reduced, rather than eliminated, the fault.

Choose by meaning, not by surface similarity

Neighbouring structures may contain similar words but perform different jobs. Compare the three reference patterns and name the intended effect before completing the sentence.

A reliable answer explains both why the chosen form works and why a plausible alternative would change the meaning, time relation, information focus or level of certainty.

Meaning	Best route
direct action sequence with an explicit actor implied	Instructional grammar
a documented process with the sequence and result foregrounded	Report grammar
a calibrated interpretation of evidence	Analytical grammar

Register, discourse and editorial control

This grammar is especially useful in cross-genre editing at proficient level. Its value comes from helping the reader process a relationship efficiently, not from making the sentence sound artificially complex.

After editing, check recoverability, natural word order and consistency with the surrounding paragraph. If the marked structure creates ambiguity, return to a fuller or more neutral clause.

Reason through the pattern

The visual map moves from communicative purpose to structural trigger, then to the final clause. It keeps meaning and form visible at the same time so the learner can justify every choice.

01	02
stable proposition	genre purpose -> grammar and information design

DECIDE IN THIS ORDER

STEP 1

Decision 1

Identify the communicative purpose before selecting a form: choose grammar that fulfils a genre's social purpose rather than merely sounding formal.

STEP 2

Decision 2

Locate the structural trigger and match it to one of the reference patterns.

STEP 3

Decision 3

Check time reference, clause relationships, agency and speaker commitment.

STEP 4

Decision 4

Read the complete sentence in context and confirm that its register suits cross-genre editing at proficient level.

STEP 5

Decision 5

Compare the result with a neutral alternative and keep the marked form only when it adds useful meaning.

Compare forms and meanings

Use the table to justify each structural choice.

Pattern	Form	Model
Instructional grammar	imperative/clear modal + ordered action	Restart the unit before running the diagnostic again.
Report grammar	passive/result-first + explicit evidence	The unit was restarted before the diagnostic was repeated.
Analytical grammar	stance + abstract relation + evidence boundary	The restart appears to have reduced, rather than eliminated, the fault.

EXAMPLES AT A GLANCE

Restart the unit before running the diagnostic again.	direct action sequence with an explicit actor implied
The unit was restarted before the diagnostic was repeated.	a documented process with the sequence and result foregrounded
The restart appears to have reduced, rather than eliminated, the fault.	a calibrated interpretation of evidence

COMMON ERRORS

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not nominalise simple actions until the procedure becomes harder to follow.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not suppress the agent if responsibility is part of the report question.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not transform a cautious analytical claim into an unqualified fact.

Recognition in context

Choose the sentence whose grammar matches the stated communicative purpose.

A1 · MEANING DECISION 1

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: direct action sequence with an explicit actor implied?

OPTIONS Restart the unit before running the diagnostic again. · The unit was restarted before the diagnostic was repeated. · The restart appears to have reduced, rather than eliminated, the fault.

A2 · MEANING DECISION 2

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a documented process with the sequence and result foregrounded?

OPTIONS The unit was restarted before the diagnostic was repeated. · The restart appears to have reduced, rather than eliminated, the fault. · Restart the unit before running the diagnostic again.

A3 · MEANING DECISION 3

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a calibrated interpretation of evidence?

OPTIONS The restart appears to have reduced, rather than eliminated, the fault. · Restart the unit before running the diagnostic again. · The unit was restarted before the diagnostic was repeated.

A4 · INTERPRETATION 4

What does “Restart the unit before running the diagnostic again.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS direct action sequence with an explicit actor implied · a documented process with the sequence and result foregrounded · a calibrated interpretation of evidence

A5 · INTERPRETATION 5

What does “The unit was restarted before the diagnostic was repeated.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a documented process with the sequence and result foregrounded · a calibrated interpretation of evidence · direct action sequence with an explicit actor implied

A6 · INTERPRETATION 6

What does “The restart appears to have reduced, rather than eliminated, the fault.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a calibrated interpretation of evidence · direct action sequence with an explicit actor implied · a documented process with the sequence and result foregrounded

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Form and function

Identify both the structural family and the meaning carried by each model.

B1 · FORM AND FUNCTION 1

"Restart the unit before running the diagnostic again." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Instructional grammar / Report grammar / Analytical grammar · Gap 2: direct action sequence with an explicit actor implied / a documented process with the sequence and result foregrounded / a calibrated interpretation of evidence

B2 · FORM AND FUNCTION 2

"The unit was restarted before the diagnostic was repeated." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Report grammar / Analytical grammar / Instructional grammar · Gap 2: a documented process with the sequence and result foregrounded / a calibrated interpretation of evidence / direct action sequence with an explicit actor implied

B3 · FORM AND FUNCTION 3

"The restart appears to have reduced, rather than eliminated, the fault." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Analytical grammar / Instructional grammar / Report grammar · Gap 2: a calibrated interpretation of evidence / direct action sequence with an explicit actor implied / a documented process with the sequence and result foregrounded

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Guided discourse choices

Maintain accurate form and meaning across a connected sequence of decisions.

C1 · EDITORIAL PLANNING

Choose the model that expresses direct action sequence with an explicit actor implied: _____. Choose the model that expresses a documented process with the sequence and result foregrounded: _____. Choose the model that expresses a calibrated interpretation of evidence: _____. Choose the model built with imperative/clear modal + ordered action: _____. Choose the model built with passive/result-first + explicit evidence: _____. Choose the model built with stance + abstract relation + evidence boundary: _____.

_____
_____

WORD BANK

Available forms

Restart the unit before running the diagnostic again. · The restart appears to have reduced, rather than eliminated, the fault. · The unit was restarted before the diagnostic was repeated.

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Open reconstruction

Recover the missing structural trigger without a word bank.

D1 · INDEPENDENT RECONSTRUCTION

_____ before running the diagnostic again. The unit _____ before the diagnostic was repeated. The restart _____, rather than eliminated, the fault. State the full structural pattern for Instructional grammar: _____. State the full structural pattern for Report grammar: _____.

_____
_____
_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Controlled transformation

Rewrite the neutral source so that it performs the requested advanced function.

E1 · TRANSFORMATION 1

Rewrite “The user should restart the unit before testing.” using the Instructional grammar pattern to express direct action sequence with an explicit actor implied.

_____
_____

E2 · TRANSFORMATION 2

Rewrite “Technicians restarted the unit and repeated the diagnostic.” using the Report grammar pattern to express a documented process with the sequence and result foregrounded.

_____
_____

E3 · TRANSFORMATION 3

Rewrite “The fault improved after restart but did not disappear.” using the Analytical grammar pattern to express a calibrated interpretation of evidence.

_____
_____

E4 · TRANSFORMATION 4

Rewrite “The user should restart the unit before testing.” using the Instructional grammar pattern to express direct action sequence with an explicit actor implied.

_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Communicative production

Use the grammar independently in realistic academic, professional and conversational contexts.

F1 · PRODUCTION TASK 1

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Instructional grammar to express direct action sequence with an explicit actor implied, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F2 · PRODUCTION TASK 2

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Report grammar to express a documented process with the sequence and result foregrounded, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F3 · PRODUCTION TASK 3

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Analytical grammar to express a calibrated interpretation of evidence, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

Final self-check

Complete these prompts without reopening the guide.

R1 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: communicative purpose.

_____
_____
_____

R2 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: structural trigger.

_____
_____
_____

R3 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: meaning contrast.

_____
_____
_____

R4 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: register choice.

_____
_____
_____

Recognition in context

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

A1

Restart the unit before running the diagnostic again.

Instructional grammar is the best match because direct action sequence with an explicit actor implied.

A2

The unit was restarted before the diagnostic was repeated.

Report grammar is the best match because a documented process with the sequence and result foregrounded.

A3

The restart appears to have reduced, rather than eliminated, the fault.

Analytical grammar is the best match because a calibrated interpretation of evidence.

A4

direct action sequence with an explicit actor implied

The Instructional grammar pattern communicates direct action sequence with an explicit actor implied.

A5

a documented process with the sequence and result foregrounded

The Report grammar pattern communicates a documented process with the sequence and result foregrounded.

A6

a calibrated interpretation of evidence

The Analytical grammar pattern communicates a calibrated interpretation of evidence.

Form and function

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

B1

Instructional grammar / direct action sequence with an explicit actor implied

The structure belongs to the Instructional grammar pattern. Its communicative purpose is direct action sequence with an explicit actor implied.

B2

Report grammar / a documented process with the sequence and result foregrounded

The structure belongs to the Report grammar pattern. Its communicative purpose is a documented process with the sequence and result foregrounded.

B3

Analytical grammar / a calibrated interpretation of evidence

The structure belongs to the Analytical grammar pattern. Its communicative purpose is a calibrated interpretation of evidence.

Guided discourse choices

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

C1

Restart the unit before running the diagnostic again.

Instructional grammar: imperative/clear modal + ordered action.

C2

The unit was restarted before the diagnostic was repeated.

Report grammar: passive/result-first + explicit evidence.

C3

The restart appears to have reduced, rather than eliminated, the fault.

Analytical grammar: stance + abstract relation + evidence boundary.

C4

Restart the unit before running the diagnostic again.

Instructional grammar: imperative/clear modal + ordered action.

C5

The unit was restarted before the diagnostic was repeated.

Report grammar: passive/result-first + explicit evidence.

C6

The restart appears to have reduced, rather than eliminated, the fault.

Analytical grammar: stance + abstract relation + evidence boundary.

Open reconstruction

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

D1

Restart the unit

Instructional grammar requires “Restart the unit” in this model. imperative/clear modal + ordered action.

D2

was restarted

Report grammar requires “was restarted” in this model. passive/result-first + explicit evidence.

D3

appears to have reduced

Analytical grammar requires “appears to have reduced” in this model. stance + abstract relation + evidence boundary.

D4

imperative/clear modal + ordered action

Instructional grammar is built as imperative/clear modal + ordered action.

D5

passive/result-first + explicit evidence

Report grammar is built as passive/result-first + explicit evidence.

Controlled transformation

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

E1

Restart the unit before running the diagnostic again.

imperative/clear modal + ordered action. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended instructional grammar effect.

E2

The unit was restarted before the diagnostic was repeated.

passive/result-first + explicit evidence. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended report grammar effect.

E3

The restart appears to have reduced, rather than eliminated, the fault.

stance + abstract relation + evidence boundary. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended analytical grammar effect.

E4

Restart the unit before running the diagnostic again.

imperative/clear modal + ordered action. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended instructional grammar effect.

Communicative production

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

F1

Restart the unit before running the diagnostic again. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses imperative/clear modal + ordered action accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F2

The unit was restarted before the diagnostic was repeated. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses passive/result-first + explicit evidence accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F3

The restart appears to have reduced, rather than eliminated, the fault. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses stance + abstract relation + evidence boundary accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

Diagnose the pattern, not only the score

Use this page to decide what to revisit in the complete guide.

CHECK · TRIGGER OR CONTEXT

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · AUXILIARY OR STRUCTURAL CHOICE

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MAIN VERB OR CLAUSE FORM

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MEANING AND REGISTER

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____